



آمار و احتمال مهندسی

Engineering Probability & Statistics

Lecture Notes ▪ جزوه درسی

Module 10

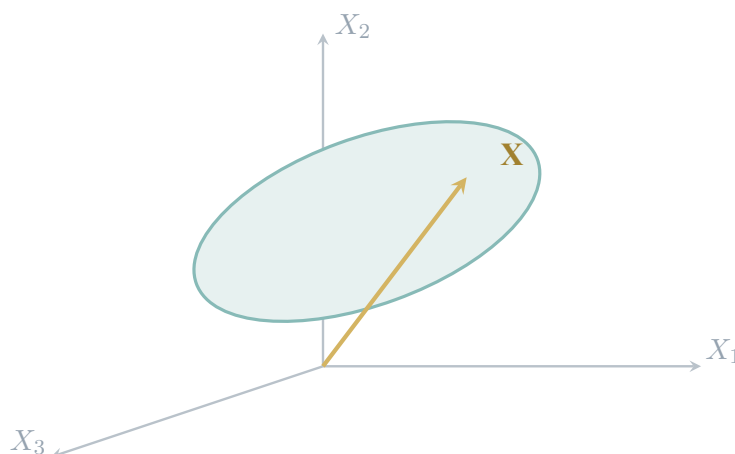
Multiple Random Variables

چند متغیر تصادفی

Instructor: Amin Azari

Compiled by: Aidin Shekari

استاد: امین آذری github.com/AminAzari



In This Module

10.1	Introduction: From 2 to N Variables	3
10.2	Joint Distributions for N Random Variables	4
10.3	Random Vectors	5
10.4	Mean Vector	6
10.5	Covariance Matrix	7
10.6	Multivariate Gaussian Distribution	8
10.7	Linear Transformations of Random Vectors	9
10.8	MATLAB Examples	10
10.9	Practice Problems	12

Learning Objectives

After completing this module, students will be able to:

1. Extend joint distributions to N random variables
2. Define and work with random vectors
3. Compute mean vectors and covariance matrices
4. Apply the multivariate Gaussian distribution
5. Perform linear transformations of random vectors

10.1 Introduction: From 2 to N Variables

Real systems often involve many uncertain quantities simultaneously:

- ▶ **Sensor array:** N sensors each producing a noisy measurement
- ▶ **MIMO system:** $M \times N$ channel coefficients
- ▶ **Parameter estimation:** p unknown parameters
- ▶ **Signal samples:** N consecutive noise samples

We need a framework for **N-dimensional** random vectors.

10.2 Joint Distributions for N Random Variables

■ Joint PDF

For $X_1, X_2, \dots, X_n$:

$$f_{X_1, \dots, X_n}(x_1, \dots, x_n) \geq 0, \quad \int \cdots \int f_{X_1, \dots, X_n} dx_1 \cdots dx_n = 1$$

■ Marginal Distributions

Integrate (or sum) out unwanted variables:

$$f_{X_1}(x_1) = \int \cdots \int f_{X_1, \dots, X_n}(x_1, \dots, x_n) dx_2 \cdots dx_n$$

■ Conditional Distributions

$$f_{X_1|X_2, \dots, X_n}(x_1|x_2, \dots, x_n) = \frac{f_{X_1, \dots, X_n}(x_1, \dots, x_n)}{f_{X_2, \dots, X_n}(x_2, \dots, x_n)}$$

■ Mutual Independence

$X_1, \dots, X_n$ are mutually independent if:

$$f_{X_1, \dots, X_n}(x_1, \dots, x_n) = \prod_{i=1}^n f_{X_i}(x_i)$$

10.3 Random Vectors

Definition

A **random vector** is an ordered collection of random variables:

$$\mathbf{X} = \begin{bmatrix} X_1 \\ X_2 \\ \vdots \\ X_n \end{bmatrix}$$

■ Engineering Examples

Random Vector	Components	Context
Sensor array output	$X_1, \dots, X_n =$ sensor readings	Array processing
MIMO channel	$h_1, \dots, h_n =$ channel gains	Wireless communications
Noise vector	$N_1, \dots, N_n =$ noise samples	Signal processing
State vector	Position, velocity, acceleration	Kalman filtering
Feature vector	Extracted measurements	Pattern recognition

10.4 Mean Vector

Definition

$$\boldsymbol{\mu} = E[\mathbf{X}] = \begin{bmatrix} E[X_1] \\ E[X_2] \\ \vdots \\ E[X_n] \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \mu_1 \\ \mu_2 \\ \vdots \\ \mu_n \end{bmatrix}$$

■ Properties

- ▶ $E[\mathbf{A}\mathbf{X} + \mathbf{b}] = \mathbf{A}E[\mathbf{X}] + \mathbf{b} = \mathbf{A}\boldsymbol{\mu} + \mathbf{b}$
- ▶ Linearity extends to vectors and matrices

10.5 Covariance Matrix

Definition

$$\Sigma = E[(\mathbf{X} - \boldsymbol{\mu})(\mathbf{X} - \boldsymbol{\mu})^T]$$

Element (i,j): $\Sigma_{ij} = \text{Cov}(X_i, X_j)$

$$\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} \sigma_1^2 & \text{Cov}(X_1, X_2) & \cdots & \text{Cov}(X_1, X_n) \\ \text{Cov}(X_2, X_1) & \sigma_2^2 & \cdots & \text{Cov}(X_2, X_n) \\ \vdots & & \ddots & \vdots \\ \text{Cov}(X_n, X_1) & \cdots & \cdots & \sigma_n^2 \end{bmatrix}$$

■ Properties

1. **Symmetric:** $\Sigma = \Sigma^T$
2. **Positive semi-definite:** $\mathbf{v}^T \Sigma \mathbf{v} \geq 0$ for all $\mathbf{v}$
3. **Diagonal = variances:** $\Sigma_{ii} = \text{Var}(X_i)$
4. **Off-diagonal = covariances:** $\Sigma_{ij} = \text{Cov}(X_i, X_j)$
5. **Independent components** $\rightarrow$ **diagonal** Σ

■ Alternative Formula

$$\Sigma = E[\mathbf{X}\mathbf{X}^T] - \boldsymbol{\mu}\boldsymbol{\mu}^T$$

10.6 Multivariate Gaussian Distribution

Definition

$\mathbf{X} \sim \mathcal{N}(\boldsymbol{\mu}, \boldsymbol{\Sigma})$ has PDF:

$$f_{\mathbf{X}}(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{1}{(2\pi)^{n/2} |\boldsymbol{\Sigma}|^{1/2}} \exp \left(-\frac{1}{2} (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu})^T \boldsymbol{\Sigma}^{-1} (\mathbf{x} - \boldsymbol{\mu}) \right)$$

where $|\boldsymbol{\Sigma}|$ = determinant of $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}$.

■ Key Properties

1. **Marginals are Gaussian:** Any subset of components is jointly Gaussian
2. **Conditionals are Gaussian:** $X_1|X_2=x_2$ is Gaussian
3. **Linear transformations:** $\mathbf{Y} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{X} + \mathbf{b} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}\boldsymbol{\mu} + \mathbf{b}, \mathbf{A}\boldsymbol{\Sigma}\mathbf{A}^T)$
4. **Uncorrelated = Independent** (unique to Gaussian!)
5. **Fully specified** by $\boldsymbol{\mu}$ and $\boldsymbol{\Sigma}$ (only 2 parameters needed per variable plus correlations)

■ Why So Important?

- Central Limit Theorem: sums of many RVs $\rightarrow$ multivariate Gaussian
- Thermal noise vectors are multivariate Gaussian
- Analytically tractable (closed-form marginals, conditionals)
- Optimal filters (Kalman, Wiener) assume Gaussian

■ 2D Case (Bivariate Gaussian)

For $n=2$ with $\boldsymbol{\mu} = [0,0]^T$, $\sigma_1 = \sigma_2 = 1$:

$$f(x, y) = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{1-\rho^2}} \exp \left(-\frac{x^2 - 2\rho xy + y^2}{2(1-\rho^2)} \right)$$

Contours are **ellipses** (tilted when $\rho \neq 0$).

10.7 Linear Transformations of Random Vectors

■ Transformation $\mathbf{Y} = \mathbf{A}\mathbf{X} + \mathbf{b}$

If $\mathbf{X}$ is a random vector with mean μ_X and covariance Σ_X :

$$E[\mathbf{Y}] = \mathbf{A}\mu_X + \mathbf{b}$$

$$\Sigma_Y = \mathbf{A}\Sigma_X\mathbf{A}^T$$

■ Engineering Applications

Beamforming: Output $y = \mathbf{w}^T \mathbf{X}$ (weight vector applied to sensor array)

- ▶ $E[y] = \mathbf{w}^T \mu$
- ▶ $\text{Var}(y) = \mathbf{w}^T \Sigma \mathbf{w}$

Whitening: Find matrix $\mathbf{W}$ such that $\mathbf{W}\Sigma\mathbf{W}^T = \mathbf{I}$ (decorrelates data)

- ▶ $\mathbf{W} = \Sigma^{-1/2}$

Principal Component Analysis: Rotate to diagonalize Σ

10.8 MATLAB Examples

Example 1: Generating Multivariate Gaussian

MATLAB

```
% Generate and Visualize 2D Gaussian Random Vector
mu = [1; 2];
Sigma = [4, 2; 2, 3]; % Covariance matrix

N = 5000;
X = mvnrnd(mu', Sigma, N);

figure;
scatter(X(:,1), X(:,2), 5, 'b', '.');
hold on;
plot(mu(1), mu(2), 'r+', 'MarkerSize', 15, 'LineWidth', 3);
xlabel('X_1'); ylabel('X_2');
title('Bivariate Gaussian Samples');
axis equal; grid on;

% Verify statistics
fprintf('Mean: [%.2f, %.2f] (theory: [%.1f, %.1f])\n', mean(X), mu');
fprintf('Cov matrix:\n'); disp(cov(X));
```

Example 2: Linear Transformation

MATLAB

```
% Transform: Y = AX + b
mu_x = [0; 0]; Sigma_x = eye(2); % Standard normal
A = [2, 1; -1, 3]; b = [1; -2];

N = 10000;
X = mvnrnd(mu_x', Sigma_x, N);
Y = A*X + b;

% Theoretical
mu_y_theory = A*mu_x + b;
Sigma_y_theory = A*Sigma_x*A';

fprintf('E[Y] theory: [%.1f; %.1f], sim: [%.2f; %.2f]\n', ...
    mu_y_theory, mean(Y,2));
fprintf('Σ_Y theory:\n'); disp(Sigma_y_theory);
fprintf('Σ_Y simulated:\n'); disp(cov(Y));
```

Example 3: Sensor Array with Correlated Noise

MATLAB

```

%% 4-Element Sensor Array with Spatially Correlated Noise
n_sensors = 4;
sigma2 = 1;      % Noise power per sensor
rho = 0.6;       % Adjacent sensor correlation

% Build covariance matrix (exponential decay model)
Sigma = zeros(n_sensors);
for i = 1:n_sensors
    for j = 1:n_sensors
        Sigma(i,j) = sigma2 * rho^abs(i-j);
    end
end

fprintf('Noise covariance matrix:\n'); disp(Sigma);

% Generate noise samples
N_samp = 10000;
L = chol(Sigma, 'lower');
noise = L * randn(n_sensors, N_samp);

% Signal present in direction: s = [1; 1; 1; 1] (broadside)
signal = 3;
s = ones(n_sensors, 1) / sqrt(n_sensors);
received = signal * s + noise; % N_sensors x N_samp

% Beamformer output: y = w'*received (w = s for matched filter)
w = s;
y = w' * received;
SNR_out = signal^2 / (w'*Sigma*w);
fprintf('Output SNR = %.2f (%.1f dB)\n', SNR_out, 10*log10(SNR_out));

```

10.9 Practice Problems

Problem 1

Random vector $X = [X_1, X_2, X_3]^T$ with $\mu = [1, 0, -1]^T$, and covariance matrix $\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & -1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$.

- (a) Find $\text{Var}(X_1 + X_2 + X_3)$. (b) Find $\text{Cov}(X_1, X_2 + X_3)$. (c) Are X_1 and X_3 uncorrelated?

Solution

(a) $\text{Var}(X_1 + X_2 + X_3) = 1^T \Sigma 1 = 4 + 2 + 3 + 2(1) + 2(0) + 2(-1) = 9 + 0 = 9$

Wait: $= \sum_{ij} \text{all entries} = 4 + 1 + 0 + 1 + 2 + (-1) + 0 + (-1) + 3 = 9$

(b) $\text{Cov}(X_1, X_2 + X_3) = \text{Cov}(X_1, X_2) + \text{Cov}(X_1, X_3) = 1 + 0 = 1$

(c) $\text{Cov}(X_1, X_3) = 0$, so yes, X_1 and X_3 are uncorrelated.

Problem 2

$X \sim N(0, \Sigma)$ with $\Sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \rho \\ \rho & 1 \end{bmatrix}$. Find the conditional distribution of $X_1 | X_2 = x_2$.

Solution For bivariate Gaussian:

$$X_1 | X_2 = x_2 \sim N(\mu_1 + \rho(\sigma_1/\sigma_2)(x_2 - \mu_2), \sigma_1^2(1 - \rho^2))$$

$$= N(\rho x_2, 1 - \rho^2)$$

The conditional mean is a linear function of x_2 , and conditional variance is reduced by factor $(1 - \rho^2)$.

Problem 3

Write MATLAB code to generate a 3D Gaussian vector with given μ and Σ , compute the sample covariance, and verify.

Solution

```
mu = [1; 0; -1];
Sigma = [4 1 0; 1 2 -1; 0 -1 3];
N = 50000;
X = mvnrnd(mu', Sigma, N);
fprintf('Sample mean: '); disp(mean(X));
fprintf('Sample cov:\n'); disp(cov(X));
```

MATLAB

Next Module: Module 11 — Central Limit Theorem